

pebble



Pebble 2 Duo



Pebble Round 2



Pebble Time 2

Why do you need more?

pebble



Pebble 2 Duo



Pebble Round 2



Pebble Time 2

Why do you need more?

What is Pebble?

The smartwatch that does exactly what you need — nothing more, nothing less

"Build awesome smartwatches and gadgets, for ourselves and like-minded folks. No investors. Mostly open source. We just dream up devices we'd like to use and build them."

2013

Original launch

First smartwatch
to reach mass market

\$10.3M

Kickstarter 2012

Record-breaking
crowdfunding

2M+

Watches sold

\$230M revenue
before acquisition

2025

Pebble is back

Open-source OS,
new hardware

Always-on e-paper

30-day battery

Open SDK

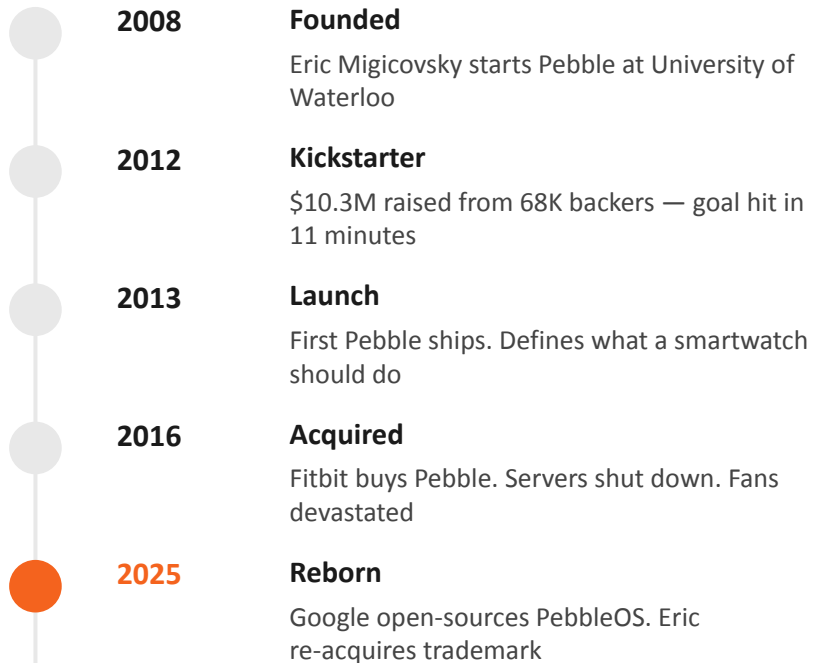
iOS & Android

Water resistant

Step & sleep tracking

The Pebble story

Died in 2016. Refused to stay dead.



The community didn't wait

After shutdown, fans built Rebble.io — self-hosted servers keeping all Pebbles alive. 10,000+ apps maintained by volunteers. The brand died. The love never did.

SMARTWATCH MARKET COMPETITORS

Feature-heavy Smartphone Extension

“Do everything”

Apple, Samsung, Galaxy, Google
Watches



Fitness-focused Devices

“Optimize one thing”

Garmin, Fittrack Atria 2.0



Long Battery Minimalist Devices

“Do less, better”

Niche Devices (Pebble, other brands
rising – xiaomi, huawei, etc.)



SMARTWATCH MARKET COMPETITORS

"Garmin is like a smarter Casio. Pebble is like a Gameboy-vibed Apple Watch." — internal team positioning

Brand	Battery	Price	Display	Target user	Pebble threat?
Apple Watch	18 hrs	\$399+	OLED	iPhone power users	Low — different segment
Samsung Galaxy	1–2 days	\$249+	AMOLED	Android mainstream	Low — feature-heavy
Garmin Fenix	14 days	\$599+	MIP/LCD	Serious athletes	Medium — battery overlap
Fitbit Sense	6 days	\$199+	AMOLED	Fitness beginners	Low — health focused
Pebble 2 Duo	30 days	~\$150	e-Paper	Minimalists / hackers	— (it's us)

Key insight: No competitor offers 30-day battery + open SDK + minimalist design at \$150. That's Pebble's unclaimed territory.

Pebble 2 Duo vs. the rest

Less is more — and here's what that looks like in practice

30-Day Battery Life

Charging less is better. Spend more time living and less time tethered to a wall.

Always-On e-Paper

Clarity over flashiness. Read your watch in direct sunlight without missing a beat.

Tactile Controls

Buttons for a practical world. Control your experience without looking at a screen.

Minimalist Design

A watch should not feel like another noisy screen on your wrist.

Core Utility

Time, notifications, steps, and sleep. Everything you need, nothing you don't.

Pebble stands out against Garmin and Amazfit by offering less: less charging, less distraction, less complexity.

New Pebble — built different

Two new models. Same philosophy. Stronger than ever.

Pebble 2 Duo

The everyday essential

Display	1.28" B&W e-paper
Battery	Up to 30 days
Charging	USB-C adapter
Design	Minimal, classic Pebble look
OS	Open-source PebbleOS
Price	~\$150

Pebble Time 2

The premium upgrade

Display	1.5" color e-paper (64 colors)
Battery	Extended (color model)
Health	Heart rate monitor
Body	Premium stainless steel
OS	Open-source PebbleOS
Feel	Classic Pebble, evolved

Why Pebble

Evidence of user love

\$10.3M

Kickstarter 2012

Goal hit in 11 minutes · 68,000 backers

2M+

Watches sold

\$230M in total revenue

\$20M+

Kickstarter 2015

Repeat fanbase confirmed

Developer ecosystem

10,000+ third-party apps & watchfaces — fans didn't just buy the watch, they built for it.

Community kept it alive

After Fitbit acquisition, users built Rebble.io to self-host Pebble servers — entirely unprompted.

"I saw another father with a Pebble Time on his wrist at the playground a few weeks ago." — Eric Migicovsky, Founder (2022)

So what went wrong?

The founder's own post-mortem — marketing was the critical failure

"Our marketing efforts were pretty awful. We basically dropped units into Best Buy and Amazon and expected them to sell. We didn't synchronize a campaign across all channels or build a strong influencer network. We wavered on hiring a head of marketing for years."

— Eric Migicovsky, Founder & CEO, Pebble (2022)

No campaign sync

Channels weren't coordinated —
Kickstarter buzz didn't carry into retail

No influencer network

Relied on organic goodwill instead of
building deliberate amplification

No marketing leadership

Wavered on hiring a CMO for years —
strategy was rudderless

Our 3 marketing solutions directly address each of these failures →

Problem space

A real gap — and Pebble was the only fit

The problem

- Checking your phone breaks focus
- Smartwatches either too expensive or too dumb
- 1-day battery life means not truly wearable
- No open, hackable option for tech-savvy users

Why competitors missed

- Apple Watch — \$350+, 1-day battery
- Fitness trackers — too limited in function
- Kindle parallel: does less, wins on focus
- No open developer platform existed

Pebble's answer

7-day battery (e-ink)

Open SDK

~\$150

Notifications + music

Customizable watchfaces

Value proposition

Simple does more — and here's our plan to bring it back

Pebble is the only smartwatch that does exactly what you need — nothing more, nothing less.

30 days

Battery life

vs 1–2 days for competitors

~\$150

Price point

Half the Apple Watch

10K+

Apps & watchfaces

Open SDK, community built

Our marketing plan

01

**Identify goal
of marketing**

02

**Identify target
customer**

03

**Marketing
solutions**

04

**Measure &
evaluate**

MARKETING GOALS

Main goal

Establish Pebble as the leading minimalist smartwatch brand in the "digital detox" market

→ Not mass adoption

→ Not competing with Apple

→ Focus: niche leadership

01 Niche market leadership

Capture the minimalist / long-battery smartwatch segment currently underserved by mainstream brands. Target 15%+ of the long-battery segment.

Why now? Burnout culture + screen fatigue = growing appetite for simpler tech

02 Product credibility & reliability

Fix known bugs (notification display, iOS setup failure). Improve warranty beyond 30 days. Ensure battery claims match real usage.

Why it matters: Trust is earned before marketing can work

Target audience

Practical tech enthusiasts with an active lifestyle — 20–40 years old



Craig

28 · Software engineer

Outdoor climber & hiker

"I want a watch that helps me focus — not another screen."

PRIMARY

Digital minimalists & productivity pros

Fed up with notification overload. Values focus and intentional tech use. Prefers practical products over feature overload.

SECONDARY

Tech enthusiasts & former Pebble fans

Already knows the brand. Interested in open-source, customization, and niche tech communities. Likely to become advocates.

TERTIARY

Fitness-casual & lifestyle users

Active lifestyle — hiking, climbing, running. Wants a focused tool, not a mini smartphone. Values long battery and simplicity.

Minimal cannibalization — Pebble (minimalists) vs Apple Watch (mainstream) are fundamentally different buyers.

MARKETING SOLUTION #1 – “EARNED” MEDIA STRATEGY



Problem: No budget to compete with Apple's advertising · Solution: Use authentic fans + micro-influencers

Rebble 100

Who	Top 100 Pebble community members
What	Free Pebble 2 Duo
Cost	~\$15,000
Ask	Honest content — no scripts
Timing	Months 2–3

Micro-influencers

Who	20–30 niche tech/lifestyle creators
What	Free Pebble 2 + commission
Cost	~\$10–15,000
Ask	"No distractions" & "30 days, no charging"
Timing	Months 2–4

Expected outcome

Who	Earned impressions
What	500K+ in 90 days
Cost	Total ~\$25–30K
Ask	Credible, authentic content
Timing	Ongoing

Why earned over paid? Pebble's identity is community-built. Paid ads contradict the brand. Fans are more credible.

Ads posted in NYC

OOH campaign — a simplicity message in the noisiest city on earth



Promote as minimalist alternative

Position Pebble against feature-heavy smartwatches — not by listing specs, but by questioning the need for them.

Brand name only — no feature list

Only show brand name + watch image. Simplicity IS the message.

High-traffic NYC tech corridors

Subway stations, university campuses, Midtown office areas — wherever 20–40 yr-old tech workers commute daily.

Calm tech in a noisy city

Clean, low-text posters stand out because of what they DON'T have — making Pebble unforgettable.

OOH chosen over digital: a simplicity ad inside a cluttered newsfeed is a contradiction. The medium must match the message.

Developer & community revival

Reignite the open ecosystem that made Pebble unique — from the inside out

Why only Pebble can do this

- Open SDK — Apple Watch has no equivalent
- Rebble.io already exists
- community self-organized
- 10,000+ apps built by fans, not employees
- Embers still burning on r/pebble & r/Rebble

REVIVE

Relaunch r/pebble + r/Rebble

Pin a "Pebble is back" announcement. Seed discussion with dev team AMAs and behind-the-scenes updates.

EXCITE

Pebble Dev Challenge

Open competition for new watchfaces & apps. Prize: early Pebble 2 Duo units + feature on official channels.

AMPLIFY

Developers become advocates

Excited devs post on X, YouTube, Hackernews — earned media that reaches exactly our target: 20–40 yr-old tech enthusiasts.

"We inspired a passionate community" — Eric Migicovsky. The ember is there. This fans the flame.

Control & conclusion

How we measure success — and why this plan works

Performance evaluation

Solution	Key metric	Target	Measurement tool
Sol. 1 — Earned media	Earned impressions	500K+ in 90 days	Social listening tools
Sol. 2 — NYC OOH	Brand search volume	+30% lift (NYC geo)	Google Trends
Sol. 3 — Dev community	New app submissions	100+ in Dev Challenge	Rebble developer dashboard
Overall	Monthly active users	+20% MoM growth	Rebble server analytics

Environment analysis

Competitive

Apple Watch dominates — we sidestep it with niche positioning, not a head-on fight

Community

Rebble & r/pebble dormant but alive — low activation cost, high loyalty ceiling

Budget

Total est. ~\$40–50K — lean by design, matching Pebble's underdog identity

Pebble didn't fail because people stopped loving it. It failed because it stopped talking to the right people in the right way.